

THE

PMS

Protocol

HORMONES. BALANCE. HEALING.

BY

Swetha Ashok

WWW.THEGUTGURU.CO.IN

GUTGURU PROTOCOL

Table of Contents

01 Understanding PMS

02 Diet & PMS Symptom Relief

03 Foods to Include & Avoid

04 The PMS Plate Formula

05 Common PMS Mistakes

06 Myth Busters

CHAPTER 01

Understanding PMS

PMS is a hormonal condition affecting 75% of menstruating women — and diet is one of the most powerful interventions.



Luteal Phase Trigger

PMS symptoms emerge in the 14 days before menstruation as progesterone rises and oestrogen fluctuates — altering neurotransmitter balance.



Serotonin Drop

Falling oestrogen in the luteal phase reduces serotonin production — directly causing mood changes, irritability, and carb cravings.



Magnesium Depletion

Up to 45% of women with PMS are magnesium-deficient. Magnesium regulates both mood and uterine muscle relaxation.

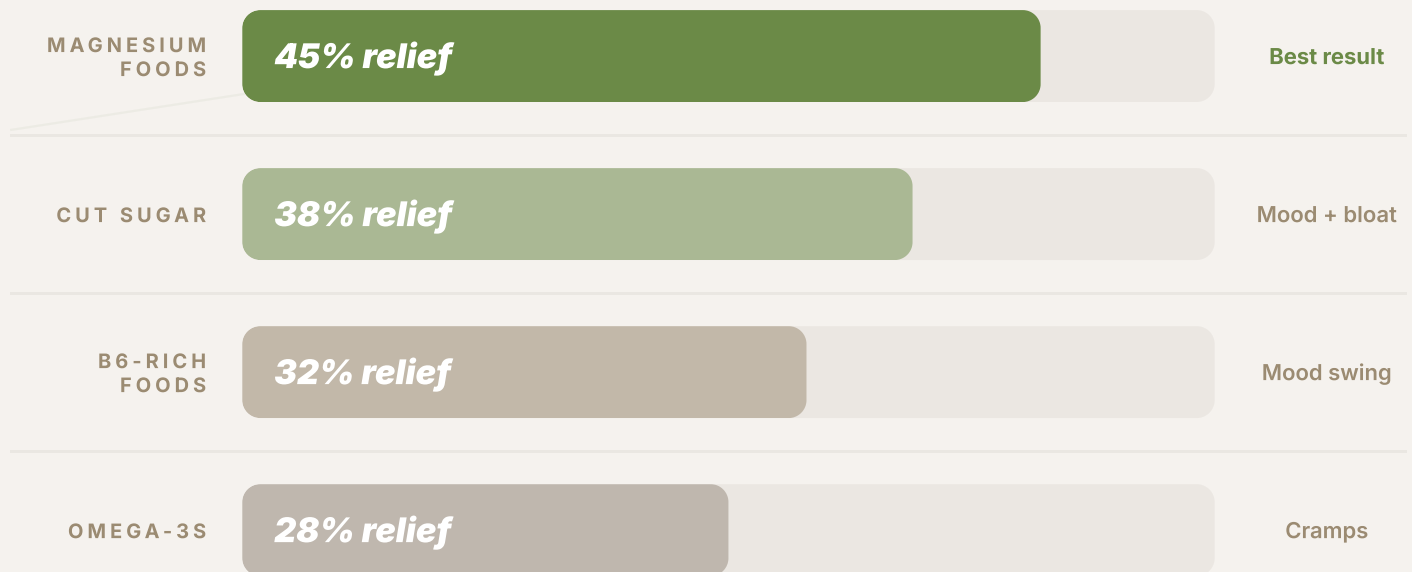


Inflammation Cycle

Prostaglandins — inflammatory compounds — drive cramps and pain. An anti-inflammatory diet significantly reduces their production.

CHAPTER 02

Diet-Based *Symptom Relief*



Clinical data shows **dietary magnesium intake reduces PMS severity by up to 45%** — comparable to low-dose supplementation, with no side effects.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Day 14 onward: increase dark leafy greens, dark chocolate (70%+), pumpkin seeds, and banana. These are your luteal-phase superfoods.

CHAPTER 03

Include vs Avoid

Strategic food choices in the 14 days before your period can dramatically shift symptom severity.

INCLUDE

Foods That Help

Anti-inflammatory, magnesium-rich, and hormone-balancing foods to prioritise from Day 14.

Dark chocolate 70%+

Pumpkin seeds

Banana

Salmon / flaxseed

Spinach

Ragi

Methi leaves

Curd

Rajma

Dates

LIMIT

Foods That Worsen

These amplify bloating, cramps, mood swings, and water retention in the luteal phase.

Table salt / salty snacks

Coffee

Alcohol

White sugar

Maida products

Processed foods

Fried snacks

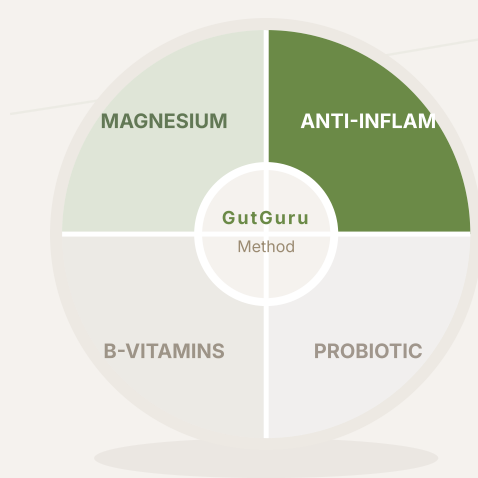
Aerated drinks

Reducing caffeine alone lowers breast tenderness by up to 60% in the luteal phase — the research is consistent.

CHAPTER 04

The PMS Plate Formula

THE GUTGURU LUTEAL PHASE METHOD

**Anti-Inflammatory Base**

Salmon, flaxseed, turmeric, ginger, walnuts

+

**Magnesium-Rich**

Pumpkin seeds, dark chocolate, spinach, ragi

+

**B-Vitamin Foods**

Eggs, sunflower seeds, banana, chickpeas

+

**Probiotic**

Curd, kanji, buttermilk, fermented pickle

EXAMPLE MEAL

Ragi roti + palak paneer + curd + 2 walnut halves**Day 14–28 — Prioritise these daily**

LUTEAL PHASE WINDOW

CHAPTER 05

Common **PMS** Mistakes

**Eating salty snacks during PMS**

Excess sodium causes fluid retention and worsens bloating — the most common PMS complaint.

**Skipping meals to manage weight**

Blood sugar crashes during the luteal phase amplify irritability and fatigue far beyond normal.

**Increasing coffee intake for energy**

Caffeine depletes magnesium and raises cortisol — directly worsening cramps, anxiety, and breast tenderness.

**Cutting complex carbs completely**

Complex carbs raise serotonin. Removing them in the luteal phase worsens the very mood symptoms you want to fix.

**Ignoring iron levels after heavy periods**

Heavy menstrual bleeding depletes iron monthly. Low ferritin is one of the most common — and missed — causes of PMS fatigue.

CHAPTER 06

Quick Myth Busters

MYTH

PMS is just mood swings — it's all in your head.

TRUTH

PMS is a clinically documented hormonal condition affecting the gut, brain, musculoskeletal system, and skin. It has measurable biochemical drivers.

MYTH

Dark chocolate is bad when you have PMS.

TRUTH

Dark chocolate (70%+) is one of the best sources of magnesium available — directly addressing one of PMS's root nutritional deficiencies.

MYTH

Birth control is the only effective solution for PMS.

TRUTH

Nutritional intervention — magnesium, B6, omega-3s, and blood sugar stabilisation — reduces PMS severity by 40–60% in clinical studies, without side effects.

TAKE THIS HOME

Your 3 Quick Wins

Three specific actions you can start this week — no equipment, no cost, measurable results.

1

Start Your Luteal Phase Food Shift

From the 14th day of your cycle, add **pumpkin seeds, dark chocolate (70%+), and ragi** to your daily meals. These three foods alone deliver the magnesium your body needs most in this phase.

FROM DAY 14 EVERY CYCLE

2

Replace Coffee With Ginger-Lemon Water

For the 5 days before your period, swap your morning coffee for **ginger + lemon + warm water**. Caffeine depletes magnesium and spikes cortisol — this one swap reduces breast tenderness and cramps measurably.

5 DAYS BEFORE YOUR PERIOD

3

Track Your Food-Mood Pattern

Write down what you eat and how you feel (energy, mood, cramps) from Day 14 onward for 2 months. You will find **your personal trigger foods** — this is more useful than any generic PMS advice.

FOR 2 CONSECUTIVE CYCLES

MORE AT www.thegutguru.co.in →



READY TO PERSONALIZE?

Book a 1-on-1 Consultation

Get a clinical nutrition plan tailored to your hormonal health,
body, and lifestyle.

 www.thegutguru.co.in



+91 9769921409



gutguru.swetha@gmail.com